

University of London
School of Oriental and African Studies
Faculty of Law & Social Sciences
Department of Development Studies

Agrarian Development, Food Policy and Rural Poverty
Course Code: 15PDSH026
2011-2012 (Term 2)
Course Convenor: Leandro Vergara-Camus
Course Level: Postgraduate

Course Teachers:

Deborah Johnston dj3@soas.ac.uk
Office Hours: Mon 12:00-14:00

Jens Lerche jl2@soas.ac.uk
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Office hours: Tue 15:00-17:00

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Lecture and Tutorial Time and Place

Lecture: Thursday 11:00-13:00 (VG122)
Tutorials: Thursday 13:00-14:00 (V319)
Thursday 14:00-15:00 (V319)
Thursday 15:00-16:00 (V309)

Lecture Topics

Term 2		Date	Lecturer
1	Role of Agriculture in Development	10 Jan	LV/CO
2	Agricultural Growth and Poverty Reduction	17 Jan	DJ
3	Population Pressure, the Environment & Agricultural Performance	24 Jan	DJ
4	Agricultural Innovation, Technological Change and GM Seeds	31 Jan	JL
5	Rural Labour Markets, Unfree Labour and Labour Standards	7 Feb	CO
Reading Week			
6	Land, Land Reform and Social Struggles	21 Feb	JL
7	Agricultural Trade and Global Value Chains	28 Feb	CO
8	Food Regimes, Food Crisis, Land Grabbing	7 Mar	LV
9	Nutrition Food Security and Social Protection	14 Mar	DJ
10	Agrarian Change: Analytical Approaches	21 Mar	CO/JL/LV

Course Description:

This course is intended for students with an interest in agrarian and rural development in the South. It provides grounding in the political economy of agrarian and rural development. The course starts out by exploring the main theories of agrarian change and the role of agriculture in development. It then moves on to a set of important specific issues and discussions regarding agrarian development and its links to overall rural development. Each topic is explored both theoretically and in specific historical and geographical contexts.

Course Organisation:

In this course you attend a weekly lecture (a two hour session) and participate in a weekly seminar. Lectures will be shared with the development studies 'Agrarian Development, Food Policy and Rural Poverty'. Lecture periods allow for some questions and discussion following the lecture. Outline notes for each lecture are posted on Moodle (see below) after the lecture has been given.

In the seminar, you are required, once in each term, to make a short presentation and lead a discussion based on the readings of the week. It is important that readings selected for class discussion are read by everyone in preparation for the weekly seminar. To best achieve the learning outcomes for the week, it is advisable that all members of the seminar group prepare a few questions or points to contribute to the seminar discussions.

Note that regular participation in seminar groups is a course requirement; if you are unable to attend a seminar group meeting you have to notify your tutor.

Course Aims:

The aim of this course is to enable students to understand and evaluate major policy debates on the role of agriculture in development. To do so, the course will consider in some depth the relevant theoretical and empirical literature on: the necessity for structural change in agriculture-dependent societies; the operation of agricultural factor and commodity markets, including international markets; the nature of rural societies and the characterisation of farmers; the nature of food markets and the role of agriculture in improving welfare. Both mainstream and heterodox approaches will be investigated.

By the end of this course students will be able to understand the major and minor strands in debates on agriculture and development. Students will also be able to analyse and compare mainstream and heterodox approaches. They will be able to apply both theory and methodology in constructing a critical analysis of the issues for a particular country. Students will be able to –

1. Provide a description of the agrarian and rural development of the South
2. Outline and compare the main theories of agrarian change and apply them in a historical context
3. Clearly show the link between agrarian development and overall rural development

Moodle:

As noted, there is page on the moodle site, for this course, where lecture notes and announcements are posted. To access moodle go to SOAS main page and click on Bloomsbury Learning Environment Login and log-in using your SOAS ID.

Methods of Assessment:

Method	Weight	Due Date
Examination	70%	May/June
2,500 Word Essay	30%	22 March 2012

Essays must be typed. Late submission penalties apply: please submit two copies of your essay to the Faculty Office before 4pm on the deadline. You must keep a copy of your essay.
The essay topics are listed at the end of each lecture outline.

Note that if you choose an essay topic from one of the lectures later in the term, you will need to work on your essay before the lecture is given, using the reading list provided for that topic.

Advice on intellectual good practice in writing essays, and rules for submitting essays, are provided in a document you will find on Blackboard on '**How to Write Good Assignments**'.

Course Outline and Reading List:

The reading list gives each week's core readings as well as additional readings.

Core readings are available electronically via the e-reading list (journal articles) or can be downloaded from the course moodle site in the case of chapters of books (marked RP). Additional readings can be found in the SOAS library, including from the many journals to which the library has an electronic subscription; sometimes you may need to find an item of additional reading in one of our sister libraries of the University of London. Recent books can, of course, also be purchased from nearby bookstores (e.g. Waterstones).

Introductory Readings:

We recommend two introductory readings.

- First, three very introductory chapters which, nevertheless, provides a good overview, by Henry Bernstein: Agrarian structures and change: Latin America; India; and sub-Saharan Africa, all in Henry Bernstein, Ben Crow, Hazel Johnson, 1992, *Rural livelihoods : crises and responses*
- Secondly, and more importantly maybe, most of the themes of the course are dealt with in a (short) book: Henry Bernstein, 2010: *Class Dynamics of Agrarian Change*, Halifax and Stirling: Fernwood and Kumarian. If you were to buy any books for this course, we strongly recommend that you buy this one! There are also several copies of the book in the library.

1. Role of Agriculture in Development (Carlos Oya)

Lecture one introduces students to the main debates that run through the course, as well as course organisation. Topics in the course include: Why is the agriculture sector often not seen as a source of rapid economic growth? Why is agriculture so central to the development agenda? This lecture will consider the role of the agricultural sector in economic development, including a discussion of: resource flows and resource mobilisation; sectoral change during economic growth; and the political economy impacts of various development paths. Lecture 1 will give an overview of the main theoretical and analytical approaches to the study of agriculture in developing countries and in processes of transition to capitalism.

Core readings

- (RP) Byres, T. (2003) 'Paths of Capitalist Agrarian Transition in the Past and in the Contemporary World', chapter 2 in V.K. Ramachandran and M. Swaminathan (eds.) *Agrarian Studies: Essays on Agrarian Relations in Less-Developed Countries*. London: Zed Books.
- (E) Kay, Cristobal (2002), 'Why East Asia overtook Latin America: agrarian reform, industrialisation and development', *Third World Quarterly*, vol 23 (6), pp. 1073-1102.[Available from [EBSCO](#)]
- (RP) Wolf, Eric (2001), "The Closed Corporate Communities in Meso-America and Central Java" and "Is the 'Peasantry' a Class?" In Wolf, Eric, *Pathways of Power. Building an Anthropology of the Modern World*, Berkeley, University of California Press, pp. 147-159, 252-259.
- (RP) Byres, T.J. (n.d.) 'Unit 4: Agriculture', mimeo.

Supplementary readings

- Bernstein H. (2009). 'Agrarian questions from transition to globalization'. In A. H. Akram-Lodhi and C. Kay (eds.) *Peasants and Globalization: Political economy, rural transformation and the agrarian question*. London: Routledge, 239-261.
- Bernstein, H (2010). *Class Dynamics of Agrarian Change* Halifax: Fernwood, ch1 -3
- Bhaduri A. (2003) 'Structural Change and Economic Development: on the relative roles of effective demand and the price mechanism in a dual economy' in H-J. Chang (ed) *Rethinking Development Economics* London: Anthem Press. Chapter 10.
- Byres, Terence J, (2003), 'Agriculture and Development: The Dominant Orthodoxy and an Alternative View' in H.J.

- Chang (ed), *Rethinking Development Economics*, London: Anthem Press, Chapter 11 [Available from the [SOAS library](#)].
- Diao, X., P. Hazell, D. Resnick and J. Thurlow (2007). *The Role of Agriculture in Development: Implications for Sub-Saharan Africa*. Discussion Paper No. 29, Development Strategy and Governance Division, International Food Policy Research Institute, Washington D.C.
- Figueroa Mark (2004) 'W. Arthur Lewis Versus the Lewis Model: Agricultural or Industrial Development?', *The Manchester School*, vol 72 (6), pp.736-750.
- Hayami, Y. (1996). 'The peasant in economic modernization'. *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 78 (5), pp. 1157–1167.
- Hayami, Y. and Vernon Ruttan (1985) *Agricultural Development: An International Perspective*, London, Johns Hopkins University Press.
- Kay, C. (2009). 'Development strategies and rural development: exploring synergies, eradicating poverty', *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 36 (1): 103-137.
- Lewis, A.W. (1954), 'Economic Development with Unlimited Supplies of Labour', *The Manchester School*, May, vol 22, no 22. Reprinted in A.N.Agarwala & S.P. Singh (eds) *The Economics of Underdevelopment*, London: Oxford University Press, 1958.
- Lipton, M. (2006). 'Can Small Farmers Survive, Prosper, or be the Key Channel to Cut Mass Poverty?' *electronic Journal of Agricultural and Development Economics*, Vol. 3, No. 1, pp. 58-85.
- Mundle, Sudipto (1985) 'The Agrarian Barrier to Industrial Growth', *Journal of Development Studies*, 22, No. 1, October.
- Rao J.M., (1986). 'Agriculture in Recent Development Theory', *Journal of Development Economics* 22: 41-86.
- Rigg, Jonathan (2006). 'Land, Farming, Livelihoods, and Poverty: Rethinking the Links in the Rural South' *World Development*, 34 (1): 180-202.
- Saith, Ashwani (2008), 'China and India: The Institutional Roots of Differential Performance', *Development and Change* 39(5):723-757.
- Sender J. and S. Smith, (1989), *Poverty, Class and Gender in Rural Africa*, Routledge, Chapter 6.
- Timmer, P. (2009). *A World without Agriculture? The Historical Paradox of Agricultural Development*, AEI Press. downloadable from <http://www.aei.org/docLib/9780844742793.pdf>
- World Bank (2007). *Agriculture for Development, World Development Report 2008*. Washington DC.

Essay question: To what extent are agricultural transformations and modernization still necessary for economic development in contemporary low-income countries? Illustrate your arguments with reference to concrete cases.

2. Agricultural growth and poverty reduction (Deborah Johnston)

This topic will look at the relationship between agricultural growth and poverty reduction. It will begin by looking at general arguments, and at the empirical evidence from Asia and Africa. How are poor affected by increases in agricultural prices or in improvements in the supply of agricultural inputs/credit? This topic will consider, inter alia: operation of rural labour markets; heterogeneity of rural poor; and rural distribution.

Core readings

- (RP) Ahluwalia, M S (1985): 'Rural Poverty, Agricultural Production and Prices: A Re-examination' p.59-75 in J W Mellor and G M Desai (eds), *Agricultural Change and Rural Poverty: Variations on a Theme* by Dharm Narain, The John Hopkins University Press, Baltimore and London. ISBN: 0-8018-3275-6
- (RP) Byres, T.J. (n.d.) 'Unit 6: Poverty', mimeo.
- (E) DFID (2004) 'Agriculture, Growth and Poverty Reduction', Working Paper. Available from: <http://dfid-agriculture-consultation.nri.org/summaries/wp1.pdf>
- (E) Prowse, Martin and Admos Chimhowu, 2007. *Making Agriculture Work for the Poor*, Overseas Development Institute, Natural Resource Perspectives 111.[Available from the [ODI website](#)]

Supplementary Readings

- Ashley, Caroline & Simon Maxwell, 2001, 'Rethinking Rural Development', *Development Policy Review*, 19(4):395-425.
- Barrett, C.B., Mesfin Bezuneh, Daniel Clay and Thomas Reardon (2001), *Heterogeneous Constraints, Incentives and Income Diversification Strategies in Rural Africa*, Department of Applied Economics and Management Working Paper, WP 2001-25, Ithaca: Cornell University
- Barrientos, Stephanie, Andrienneta Kritzing, Maggie Opondo and Sally Smith, 2005. 'Gender, Work and Vulnerability in African Horticulture'. *IDS Bulletin*, 36 (2): 74-9.
- Bryceson Deborah Fahy, 2004, 'Agrarian Vista or Vortex: African Rural Livelihood Policies', *Review of African Political*

- Cramer C. and N. Pontara, "Rural Poverty and Poverty Alleviation in Rural Mozambique: What's Missing from the Debate?", *Journal of Modern African Studies*, 36, 1 (1998), pp. 101-138.
- Cramer, Christopher, Carlos Oya and John Sender (2008), 'Rural Labour Markets in Sub-Saharan Africa: A New View of Poverty, Power and Policy', Centre for Development Policy and Research Policy Brief #1. Available from <http://www.soas.ac.uk/cdpr/publications/pb/48088.pdf> or Cramer C., C. Oya and J. Sender (2008). 'Lifting the blinkers: a new view of power, diversity and poverty in Mozambican rural labour markets'. *Journal of Modern African Studies*, 46, 3: 361-392
- Datt, G. and M. Ravallion (1998) "Why have some Indian States done better than others at reducing rural poverty?" *Economica* Vol.65.
- Desai, B M and N V Namboodiri (1998): 'Policy Strategy and Instruments for Alleviating Rural Poverty', *Economic and Political Weekly*, October 10.
- Dollar, D. and Aart Kraay (2001) 'Growth IS Good for the Poor', Washington, DC, World Bank, Development Research Group, Working Paper 2587.
- Donaldson John A., Growth is Good for Whom, When, How? Economic Growth and Poverty Reduction in Exceptional Cases, *World Development*, Volume 36, Issue 11, November 2008, Pages 2127-2143
- Ellis, F. (2010), 'Strategic Dimensions of rural Poverty Reduction in sub-Saharan Africa'. In: *The Comparative Political Economy of Development: African and South Asia*, Hariss-White B. and Heyer J. (eds). Routledge, London & New York, p. 47-63.
- Ghose, AK (1989) 'Rural Poverty and Relative Prices in India', *Cambridge Journal of Economics*, Vol. 13, No. 2 (June), pp: 307-331
- Ghosh, M. (1998) 'Agricultural Development, Agrarian Structure and Rural Poverty in West Bengal', *Economic and Political Weekly*, November 21.
- Irz, Xavier, Lin Lin, Colin Thirtle and Steve Wiggins, 2001. 'Agricultural Productivity Growth and Poverty Alleviation', *Development Policy Review* 19 (4): 449-466
- Jayaraman, Rajshri and Peter Lanjouw (1999) 'The Evolution of Poverty and Inequality in Indian Villages', *World Bank Research Observer*, February, volume 14, number 1.
- Lanjouw P and R Murgai (2008) Poverty decline, agricultural wages and non-farm employment in rural India: 1983-2004. World Bank, Policy Research Working paper 4858
- Mwabu, Germano & Erik Thorbecke, 2004, 'Rural Development, Growth & Poverty in Africa', *Journal of African Economies*, 13 (Supplement 1), pp.16-65.
- Peters P. 'Failed Magic or Social Context?: Market Liberalization and the Rural Poor in Malawi', Centre for International Development, Harvard. Processed (1996).
- Ravallion, M. (2001) 'Growth, Inequality & Poverty: Looking Beyond Averages', *World Development*, 29: 11, 1803-1815.
- Ravallion, M. and Gaurav Datt (1999) 'When is Growth Pro-Poor? Evidence from the Diverse Experiences of Indian States', World Bank, Working Paper 2263, December.
- Rigg, Jonathan (2006). 'Land, Farming, Livelihoods, and Poverty: Rethinking the Links in the Rural South' *World Development*, 34 (1): 180-202.
- Saith, Ashwani (2008), 'China and India: The Institutional Roots of Differential Performance', *Development and Change* 39(5):723-757.
- Saito, K. A. (1994). 'Raising the Productivity of Women Farmers in Sub-Saharan Africa' World Bank Discussion Papers, Africa Technical Department Series, Washington
- Sen Abhijit and Jayati Ghosh, (1993), 'Trends in Rural Employment and the Poverty Employment Linkage', ILO ARTEP Working Papers, December.
- Sender, J. (2003) Rural Poverty and Gender: Analytical Frameworks and Policy Proposals, in: Ha-Joon Chang (Ed) *Rethinking Development Economics*, pp. 401-420 (London, Anthem Press).
- World Bank (2000), *World Development Report, 2000/2001: Attacking Poverty*, Washington D.C., 2000.

Essay question: 'Development experts need greater understanding of the links between agricultural productivity and poverty. They also need to assess just how far they have changed and the extent to which small-scale agriculture can remain a ladder out of poverty' (Dfid 2004). Discuss.

3. Population pressure, the environment and agricultural performance (Deborah Johnston)

In this lecture we will look at the relationship between the environment, agricultural performance and population pressure. We will see that the debate has been artificially polarized between two questionable extremes. What does the evidence say about the impact of population growth on environmental degradation or agricultural innovation? There will be a particular focus on debate and evidence for arid and semi-arid sub-Saharan Africa.

Core readings

- (RP) Bernstein, Henry and Woodhouse, Phil 'Africa: eco-populist utopias and (micro-)capitalist realities.' P.147-169 In: Panitch, L and Leys, C, (eds.), *Socialist Register 2007. Coming to Terms with Nature*. Merlin.
- (RP) Boserup, Ester, 1981, *Population and technological change: a study of long-term trends*. University of Chicago Press. Chapters 1 (p.3-7) & 16 (p.200-11).
- (RP) Johnston, Deborah (2012) 'Population and Migration.' pp. 272-276 In: Saad Filho, Alfredo and Fine, Ben, (eds.), *The Elgar Companion to Marxist Economics*. Aldershot: Edward Elgar. Available as e-book from the SOAS Library.
- (E) Kenny, C. (2010), 'Is Anywhere Stuck in a Malthusian Trap?'. *Kyklos*, 63: 192–205.

Supplementary readings

- Bloom & Williamson, 1998. 'Demographic transition and economic miracles in emerging Asia'. *World Bank Economic Review*, 12 (3) : 419-55.
- Boyd, C. and T. Slaymaker (2000), 'Re-examining the "More People Less Erosion" Hypothesis: Special Case or Wider Trend', *Natural Resource Perspectives*, 63 (November). Available from <http://www.odi.org.uk/resources/download/1703.pdf>
- Crook, Nigel. 1996. 'Population and poverty in classical theory: testing a structural model for India'. *Population Studies*. 50(2). pp.173-186.
- Crook, Nigel. (1997). *Principles of population and development: with illustrations from Asia and Africa*. OUP
- (RP) Dyson, T. (1996), 'Pessimists and Optimists'. In: T.Dyson, *Population and Food*. London and New York: Routledge.
- Ehrlich, Paul R. (2008). 'Demography and Policy: A View from Outside the Discipline', *Population and Development Review*, 34(1), p. 103-113.
- Galor, O. and Weil, D. N. (2000). 'Population, Technology and Growth: From the Malthusian regime to the Demographic Transition'. *American Economic Review*, 90, p.806 – 28.
- Hardin Garrett, (1968) "[The Tragedy of the Commons](#)", *Science*, Vol. 162, No. 3859 (December 13, 1968), pp. 1243-1248
- Klasen, S., Nestmann, T. 2006. 'Population, population density and technological change'. *Journal of population economics*, 19(3), p611-26.
- Kling, Jeff, and Land Pritchett. (1994). "Where in the World Is Population Growth Bad?" World Bank Policy Research Working Paper 1391. See research section of World Bank website
- Leach Melissa and James Fairhead (2000), [Challenging Neo-Malthusian Deforestation Analyses in West Africa's Dynamic Forest Landscapes](#), *Population and Development Review*, Vol. 26, No. 1. (Mar., 2000), pp. 17-43.
- Leach M and R.Mearns (1996), 'Environmental Change and Policy: Challenging Received Wisdom in Africa', in Leach M & R.Mearns (eds), *The Lie of the Land: Challenging Received Wisdom on the African Environment*, Oxford: James Currey & Portsmouth (NH): Heinemann with The International African Institute.
- Mackenzie A. Fiona D. (2000) "Contested Ground: Colonial Narratives and the Kenyan Environment, 1920–1945", *Journal of Southern African Studies*, Volume 26, Number 4, December.
- McCann, J., 1999, *Green Land, Brown Land, Black Land: An Environmental History of Africa, 1800-1990*, Oxford: James Currey & Portsmouth (NH): Heinemann.
- Mortimore Michael and Mary Tiffen (2004) 'Introducing Research into Policy: Lessons from District Studies of Dryland Development in Sub-Saharan Africa'. *Development Policy Review*, 22 (3): 259-85.
- Mortimore Michael (2003), "Long-term Change in African Drylands: Can Recent History Point Towards Development Pathways?" *Oxford Development Studies*, Vol. 31, No. 4, December 2003
- Ostrom, Elinor, and Christopher B. Field. "Revisiting the commons: Local lessons, global challenges." *Science* 284.5412 (1999)
- Platteau Jean-Philippe, 1995, 'The food crisis in Africa: A comparative structural analysis', in Dreze, J., A.K. Sen and A. Hussain (eds), *The Political Economy of Hunger – Selected Essays*, Oxford: Clarendon Press, p445-553.
- Ross, E.B., (1998) *The Malthus Factor: Population, Poverty and Politics in Capitalist Development*. London & New York: Zed Books. Conclusion chapter.
- Scoones Ian and Camilla Toulmin, *Policies for Soil Fertility Management in Africa*, London: Department for International Development (DFID), 1999, p. 51.
- Siedenburg, Jules (2006), 'The Machakos Case Study: Solid Outcomes, Unhelpful Hyperbole', *Development Policy Review*, 24(1):75-85.
- Swift, J (1996), 'Desertification: narratives, winners and losers', in Leach M & R.Mearns (eds), *The Lie of the Land: Challenging Received Wisdom on the African Environment*, Oxford: James Currey & Portsmouth (NH): Heinemann with The International African Institute.
- Tiffen M. and M.Mortimore, 'Malthus Converted: The Role of Capital and Technology in Growth and Environmental Recovery in Kenya', *World Development*, 22, 7, (1994).
- Tiffen, Mary (1995), "Population Density, Economic Growth and Societies in Transition: Boserup Reconsidered in a

Essay question: ‘The most important aspect of necessity that we must now recognize, is the necessity of abandoning the commons in breeding. ... Freedom to breed will bring ruin to all.’ Discuss with reference to the impact of local population growth on agricultural performance.

4. Agricultural Innovation, Technological Change and GM Seeds (Jens Lerche)

What is agricultural innovation and how does it occur? This lecture will investigate the debate on the role of price changes versus other factors that lead to improved agricultural performance. It will include a discussion of: new technology and productivity and profitability change; price signals and neoliberal policy reform in the agricultural sector; institutional and structural change; and the political economy of policy decisions. As part of this the two paradigmatic cases of innovation and change: a) the green revolution and b) GM crops will be scrutinised.

Core readings

- (E) Herring, Ronald J., 2007, ‘Stealth Seeds: Bioproperty, Biosafety, Biopolitics’, *Journal of Development Studies* 43(1): 130–57.
- (E) Moore, Jason, 2010. ‘The End of the Road? Agricultural Revolutions in the Capitalist World-Ecology, 1450–2010’, *Journal of agrarian Change* 10(3): 389–413
- (E) Woodhouse, Philip, 2010. ‘Beyond Industrial Agriculture? Some Questions about Farm Size, Productivity and Sustainability’, *Journal of Agrarian Change* 10(3): 437–453
- (E) World Bank, 2007, ‘Innovating through science and technology’, in *World Development Report 2008: Agriculture for Development*, Washington DC: The World Bank, ch 7, pp.158-179
[Available from the [World Bank website](http://www.worldbank.org)]

Plus the relevant parts of Byres, T.J. (n.d.) ‘Unit 4: Agriculture’, mimeo (week 1)

Also recall Byres 2003 (in H-J Chang edited volume) (week 1)

Supplementary readings

- ActionAid., 2003, *GM crops –going against the grain*. Report. ActionAid
http://www.actionaid.org.uk/content/documents/gatg_2462004_1524.pdf
- Bharadwaj, K. 1985, ‘A View on Commercialization in Indian Agriculture and the Development of Capitalism’, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, July.
- Bramall, Chris 2000, *Sources of Chinese Economic Growth*, Oxford University Press. Especially Chapters 3, 14.
- Djurfeldt, G., Hans Holmén and Magnus Jirstrom, 2006, addressing food Crisis in Africa: What can sub-saharan africa learn from asian experiences in addressing its food crisis? SIDA
<http://www.eldis.org/go/home&id=23348&type=Document>
- Dorward et al 2004, “A Policy Agenda for Pro-Poor Agricultural Growth” *World Development* 32 (1): 73-89.
- Gabre-Madhin E.Z. and S. Haggblade, 2004, ‘Successes in African Agriculture: Results of an Expert Survey’, *World Development* Vol. 32, No. 5, pp. 745–766,.
- Glover, D., 2010, ‘Is BT Cotton a Pro-Poor Technology? A Review and Critique of the Empirical Record’, *Journal of Agrarian Change* 10(4): 482-509
- Gulati, Ashok and Seema Bathla, 2001, ‘Capital Formation in Indian Agriculture: Revisiting the Debate’, *Economic and Political Weekly*, May 19, 2001.
- Harrigan J., 2003, ‘U-Turns and Full Circles: Two Decades of Agricultural Reform in Malawi 1981–2000’ *World Development* 31(5): 847–63.
- Harriss, John 1992, ‘Does the ‘depressor’ still work? Agrarian structure and development in India: A review of evidence and argument’, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 19:2, 189 -227
http://pdfserve.informaworld.com/346515_751319452_790299067.pdf
- Juma, C., 2011, *The New Harvest: Agricultural Innovation in Africa*. Oxford: [Oxford University Press](http://www.oxforduniversitypress.com)
- Kay, Cristóbal 2002, ‘Chile’s Neoliberal Agrarian Transformation and the Peasantry’, *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 2(4): 464-501.
- Kherallah, M., Delgado, C., Gabre-Madhin E., Minot N. and Johnson M., 2002, *Reforming Agricultural Markets in Africa*. London: John’s Hopkins.
- Kloppenburg, J., 2010, ‘Impeding dispossession, enabling repossession: biological open source and the recovery of seed sovereignty’, *Journal of Agrarian Change* 10(3): 367-88

- Lipton M., 1987, 'The Limits of Price Policy for Agriculture: Which Way Now?', *Development Policy Review*, 5.
- Nolan, Peter, 1995, *China's Rise, Russia's Fall: Politics, Economics and Planning in the Transition from Stalinism*, Macmillan, esp. Chapter 5.
- Oya, C. 2005, 'Sticks and Carrots for Farmers in Developing Countries: Agrarian Neoliberalism in Theory and Practice', in A.Saad-Filho & D.Johnston (eds) *Neoliberalism: A Critical Reader*, ch. 14. London: Pluto
- Pray, Carl E.; Naseem, Anwar. 2007, '[Supplying crop biotechnology to the poor: Opportunities and constraints](#)', *Journal of Development Studies* 43(1): 192-217.
- Reddy, D.N. and S. Mishra, 2009, 'Agriculture in the reforms regime', in Reddy, D.N. and S. Mishra (eds), *Agrarian Crisis in India*. New Delhi: Oxford University Press, pp. 3-43.
- Schoones, Ian, 2008, '[Mobilizing Against GM Crops in India, South Africa and Brazil](#)', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 8(2/3): 315-44.
- Scoones, Ian, 2006, *Science, agriculture and the politics of policy: the case of biotechnology in India*, Hyderabad: Orient Longman.
- Scoones, I. and Thompson, 'The Politics of Seed in Africa's Green Revolution', *IDS Bulletin* 42.4 (special issue)
- Sender J., 'Africa's economic performance: limitations of the current consensus' *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 13 (3), (Summer 1999).
- Seshia S. and I. Scoones, 2003, Tracing policy connections: the politics of knowledge in the Green Revolution and biotechnology eras in India, *IDS Working Paper* 188.
- Shiva, Vandana. 2009. *Soil, not oil: climate change, peak oil and food insecurity*. London : Zed.
- Shiva, Vandana. 2005. *Globalization's new wars : seed, water & life forms*. New Delhi : Women Unlimited.
- Spoor, Max 2002, 'Policy Regimes and Performance of the Agricultural Sector in Latin America and the Caribbean During the Last Three Decades', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 2(3): 381-400.
- Weild, D., J. Chataway and M Bolo, 2010, 'Issues in the political economy of agricultural biotechnology', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 10(3): 342-66
- Weis, T., 2007, 'The temperate grain-livestock complex', in Weis, T., *The Global Food Economy. The battle for the future of farming*, London: Zed Books, pp. 47-88.
- Wiggins S., 2000, 'Interpreting Changes from the 1970s to the 1990s in African Agriculture through Village Studies', *World Development* 28(4).
- World Bank, 2007, 'Supporting smallholder competitiveness through institutional innovations', in *World Development Report 2008: Agriculture for Development*. Washington DC: The World Bank, ch. 6, pp. 138-157.

Essay question: What are the consequences of GM seeds to growers in the South and what evidence is there for possible and viable non-GM futures?

5. Rural labour markets (Carlos Oya)

This lecture considers the relationship between agrarian change, rural labour relations, different forms of labour utilisation/exploitation, surplus labour and the emergence of rural labour markets and rural wage employment in agrarian (capitalist) transitions. How can rural labour markets and patterns of hired labour be characterised in developing countries? The lecture also engages with current debates on the role of rural labour markets in poverty reduction and the extent to which there is a process of de-agrarianisation with the development of the 'rural non-farm economy'. Finally the session will discuss alternative labour policy options with a focus on the most disadvantaged labour market entrants.

Core readings

- (E) Cramer C., C. Oya and J. Sender (2008). 'Lifting the blinkers: a new view of power, diversity and poverty in Mozambican rural labour markets'. *Journal of Modern African Studies*, 46, 3: 361-39 [Available from [Cambridge Journals](#)]
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Supplementary readings

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Essay question: Explore and discuss key similarities and differences between rural labour markets in African countries (excluding South Africa) and India.

6. Land, land reform and social struggles (Jens Lerche)

Is the manner in which land is held and operated important? What is the role of tenure reform in economic and social change? Why has land redistribution re-emerged in the international policy debate? How do land reform initiatives of today differ from those of the past, and who benefits from them? This lecture will consider the theoretical and empirical literature on tenure reform and land redistribution, drawing on a range of historical and contemporary experiences.

Core Readings

- (E) Bernstein, H. 2007, 'Agrarian Questions of Capital and Labour: Some Theory about Land Reform (and a Periodisation)', in L. Ntsebeza and R. Hall (eds.) 2009, *The Land Question in South Africa. The Challenge of Transformation and Redistribution*, Cape Town: HSRC Press.
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- (E) Philip McMichael, 2006. 'Reframing development: global peasant movements and the new agrarian question.' *Canadian Journal of Development Studies*, 27 (4): 471-483.
- (E) Sender, J. and D. Johnston 2004, 'Searching for a Weapon of Mass Production in Rural Africa: Unconvincing Arguments for Land Reform', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 4(1&2): 142-64.
- (E) Vergara-Camus, L., 2009, 'The MST and the EZLN struggle for land: new forms of peasant rebellions', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 9(3): 365-91
- Plus the relevant parts of Byres, T.J. (n.d.) 'Unit 4: Agriculture', mimeo (week 1)

Supplementary readings

- Akram-Lodhi, A.H., S M Borrás Jr, C Kay and T McKinley, 2007, 'Neoliberal globalisation, land and poverty. Implications for public action', in Akram-Lodhi, A.H., S M Borrás Jr, C Kay (eds), *Land, poverty and livelihoods in an era of globalization*. London: Routledge, pp 383-98.
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- Borrás, S., 2010, The Politics of Transnational Agrarian Movements, *Development and Change* 41(5), 771-803
- Bramall, C., 2004, 'Chinese Land Reform in Long-Run Perspective and in the Wider East Asian Context', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 4(1&2) 107-41.
- Byres, T.J., 2004b, 'Introduction: Contextualizing and Interrogating the GKI Case for Redistributive Land Reform',

Journal of Agrarian Change 4(1&2): 1-16.

- Chimhowu Admos And Phil Woodhouse, 2006, 'Customary vs Private Property Rights? Dynamics and Trajectories of Vernacular Land Markets in Sub-Saharan Africa', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 6(3): 346-71.
- Cousins, B and I Scoones, 2010, Contested paradigms of 'viability' in redistributive land reform: perspectives from southern Africa, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 37(1) 31-66
- Deininger, Klaus, 1999, Making Negotiated Land Reform Work: Initial Experience from Columbia, Brazil and South Africa, *World Bank Policy Research Working Paper* no. 2040. Washington DC: World Bank.
- Deininger, Klaus 2003, Land Policies for Growth and Poverty Reduction. Washington: World Bank & Oxford University Press.
- Dyer, G., 2004, 'Redistributive Land Reform: No April Rose. The Poverty of Berry and Cline and GKI on the Inverse Relationship', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 4(1&2): 45-72.
- Griffin, K., Khan, A.R. and Ickowitz, A., 2002, 'Poverty and the Distribution of Land', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 2(3): 279-330.
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- Hall Ruth, 2004, 'A Political Economy of Land Reform in South Africa', *Review of African Political Economy*, 100: 213-27
- Jacobs, S. 2000, 'Zimbabwe: Why Land Reform is a Gender Issue', *Sociological Research Online* 5(2): 6.6,
- Johnston, D. and H. Le Roux 2007, 'Leaving the Household out of Family Labour: The Implications for the Size-Efficiency Debate', *European Journal of Development Research*.
- Kevane, M. and L.C. Gray 1999, 'A Woman's Field is Made at Night: Gendered Land Rights and Norms in Burkina Faso', *Feminist Economics* 5(1): 1-26.
- Khan, M.H., 2004, 'Power, Property Rights and the Issue of Land Reform: A General Case Illustrated with Reference to Bangladesh', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 4(1&2), 73-106.
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- Stedile, J.P., 2002, 'Landless Battalions: The Sem Terra Movement of Brazil,' *New Left Review*, May-June 2002.
- Walker, Cheryl, 2002. Agrarian Change, Gender And Land Reform: A South African Case Study. UNRISD Social Policy & Development Programme Paper no 10 (April).
- Woodhouse Philip, 2003, 'African Enclosures: A Default Mode of Development', *World Development* 31(10): 1705-20.

Essay question: Via Campesina states: 'No agrarian reform is acceptable that is based only on land distribution. We believe that the new agrarian reform must include a cosmic vision of the territories of communities of peasants, the landless, indigenous peoples, rural workers, fisherfolk, nomadic pastoralists, tribes, afro-descendents, ethnic minorities, and displaced peoples, who base their work on the production of food and who maintain a relationship of respect and harmony with Mother Earth and the oceans.' (McMichael 2006: 478). Compare and contrast this view of land reform, its underlying theoretical position and its political strategy with other views of land reforms today.

7. Agricultural Trade And Global Value Chains (Carlos Oya)

This lecture will consider the debates about trade in agricultural commodities, and the globalization of world agriculture in the era of neoliberalism. In what sense are agricultural markets becoming more 'globalized'? How are international agricultural markets structured, and what are the implications for producers and workers in developing countries? How are producers incorporated in global agricultural value chains? What is the significance and implications of some forms of incorporation like contract farming? How does agricultural trade liberalization affect this incorporation? How do these processes affect agrarian change and agrarian relations of production and exchange? These and other questions will be surveyed during the lecture and tutorials.

Core readings

- (E) Daviron, B. and P Gibbon (2002), 'Global Commodity Chains and African Export Agriculture', *Journal of Agrarian Change* Vol. 2 No 2. See also especially papers by Ponte, Losch and Fold. [Available from [Wiley InterScience](#)]
- (E) Gilbert C. (2008) 'Value chain analysis and market power in commodity processing with application to the cocoa and coffee sectors', in *Commodity Market Review*, Rome: FAO

- (E) Panagariya, Arvind (2005), 'Agricultural Liberalisation and the Least Developed Countries: Six Fallacies', *The World Economy*, 28(9): 1277-99.[Available from [EBSCO](#)]
- (E) UNCTAD (2009). *World Investment Report 2009. Transnational Corporations, Agricultural Production and Development*, Part II, pp. 93-190, Geneva, UNCTAD. [Available from [UNCTAD](#)]

Supplementary readings

- Agriculture and Natural Resources Team - DFID, Morrison, J. & Murphy, S. (2004) *Agricultural Trade and Poverty Reduction: Opportunity or Threat?* London: DFID
- Amanor, K.S. (2005), 'Agricultural Markets in West Africa: Frontiers, Agribusiness and Social Differentiation', *IDS Bulletin*, 36 (2), pp. 58-62.
- Barrientos, S. & Kritzing, A. (2004). 'Squaring the Circle: Global Production and the Informalization of Work in South African Fruit Exports', *Journal of International Development*, 16(1), 81-92.
- Bassett, T. J. (2010). 'Slim pickings: Fairtrade cotton in West Africa'. *Geoforum*, 41(1), 44-55.
- Bernstein H. and L. Campling, 2006. 'Commodity Studies and Commodity Fetishism I: *Trading Down*'. *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 6 (2): 239-64.
- Cashin, Paul, C. John McDermott and Alasdair Scott. (2002). 'Booms and Slumps in World Commodity Prices', *Journal of Development Economics*, vol. 69, n°1, pp. 277-296.
- Clapp, R., 1994. The Moral Economy of the Contract. In: P. Little and M. Watts eds. *Living under Contract: Contract Farming and Agrarian Transformation in Sub-Saharan Africa*. Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 78-96.
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- Dolan C., (2005). 'Benevolent Intent? The Development Encounter in Kenya's Horticulture Industry', *Journal of Asian and African Studies*, 40(6): 411-437.
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- Fold, N. (2008). 'Transnational Sourcing Practices in Ghana's Perennial Crop Sectors' *Journal of Agrarian Change* 8 (1): 94-122.
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- Gilbert, C. L. (1996). 'International Commodity Agreements: An Obituary Notice'. *World Development* 24(1): 591-616.
- Hallam, D. et al. (2004), *The market for non-traditional agricultural exports*, FAO Commodities and Trade Technical paper, Rome: FAO.
- Humphrey J. (2006) 'Policy Implications of Trends in Agribusiness Value Chains', *The European Journal of Development Research*, Vol.18, No.4, pp.572-592
- Li, T. (2011). Centering labor in the land grab debate. *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 38 (2): 281-298.
- Little, P.D. and Watts, M.J. 1994. Introduction. In: P.D. Little and M.J. Watts (eds). *Living Under Contract: Contract Farming and Agrarian Transformation in Sub-Saharan Africa*. Madison, W.I.: University of Wisconsin Press, pp. 3-11.
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- Maertens, Miet and Johan F.M. Swinnen (2009), 'Trade, Standards, and Poverty: Evidence from Senegal', *World Development*, Volume 37, Issue 1: 161-178
- Maertens, M., Colen, L., & Swinnen, J. F. (2011). 'Globalisation and poverty in Senegal: a worst case scenario?' *European Review of Agricultural Economics*, 38 (1): 31-54.
- McMichael, P. (2009). 'A food regime genealogy'. *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 36(1), 139-169.
- McMillan, Margaret, Dani Rodrik and Karen Horn Welch (2002), 'When Economic Reform Goes Wrong: Cashews in Mozambique', NBER Working Paper No. 9117
- Michelsen, H., Reardon, T., & Perez, F. (2012). 'Small Farmers And Big Retail: Trade-Offs Of Supplying Supermarkets In Nicaragua'. *World Development*, 40(2). 342-354.
- Minot Nicholas and Margaret Ngigi, (2004). 'Are horticultural exports a replicable success story? Evidence from Kenya and Côte d'Ivoire', EPTD Discussion Paper No.120 and MTID Discussion Paper No.73. Environment and Production Technology Division and Markets, Trade and Institutions Division. International Food Policy Research Institute, Washington, D.C.
- Murphy, S., Burch, D., & Clapp, J. (2012). *Cereal secrets: the world's largest grain traders and global agriculture*. Oxfam Research report.
- Newman, S. A. (2009). 'Financialization and changes in the social relations along commodity chains: the case of coffee'. *Review of Radical Political Economics*, 41(4), 539-559.

- Oya, C. (2012). 'Contract Farming in Africa: A Survey of Approaches, Debates and Issues', *Journal of Agrarian Change*, 12 (1),: 1–33.
- Poulton, C., Tyler, G., Hazell, P., Dorward, A., Kydd, J. and Stockbridge, M. 2008. *Commercial Agriculture in Africa: Lessons from Success and Failure*. Background paper for the Competitive Commercial Agriculture in Sub-Saharan Africa (CCAA) Study.
- Reardon, T., C. B. Barrett, J. A. Berdegue, J. F.M. Swinnen, (2009), 'Agri-food Industry Transformation and Small Farmers in Developing Countries', *World Development*, Volume 37, Issue 11: 1717-1727. See papers in this special issue.
- Talbot J. M. (2002) 'Tropical Commodity Chains, Forward Integration Strategies and International Inequality: Coffee, Cocoa and Tea', *Review of International Political Economy*, 9(4): 701-734
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- Wise, Timothy A. (2009). 'Promise or pitfall? The limited gains from agricultural trade liberalisation for developing countries', *Journal of Peasant Studies*. 36(4):855-870.
- World Bank. 2007. *World Development Report 2008: Agriculture for Development*, Washington D. C., the World Bank (see especially chap. 4, 5, 6).
- Zhang, Q. F., & Donaldson, J. A. (2008). 'The rise of agrarian capitalism with Chinese characteristics: Agricultural modernization, agribusiness and collective land rights'. *The China Journal*, 25-47.

Essay question: 'Exclusion and marginalization have been experienced in African agriculture as farmers fail to meet new expectations concerning quality, lead times, volumes, and prices and standards'. Discuss.

8. Food regimes, food crisis and land grabbing (Leandro Vergara-Camus)

This lecture will summarily review and critically assess the literature on food regimes, which attempts to trace and map out the ways in which food production was gradually integrated on the global scale. The lecture will thus examine how food markets have developed and the impacts this development has had on the nature of agricultural production in developing countries. It will review and assess the different ways in which we can think about national and international food production by looking at the balance of power between developed and developing states, TNCs and peasant producers. The lecture will draw on this background to analyse more recent developments such as global food crisis and land grabbing and their effects on processes of agrarian changes in developing countries. Particular attention will be put on the changing dynamics of food imports and exports, the development of large-scale investments in export agriculture targeted at specific markets, and small-holders' access to land and to national markets. The calls by peasant movements and critical scholars in favour of agro-ecology and 'food sovereignty' will also be discussed in order to assess whether these can offer a real alternative for developing states and/or small-scale producers.

Core readings

- (E) McMichael, Philip (2009), 'A Food Regime Genealogy', *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 36, no. 1, pp. 139-169.
- (E), Symposium on 2007/8 World Food Crisis, *Journal of Agrarian Change* (2010), vol 10, issue 1, articles by Ghosh, Lang and Bush.
- (E) De Schutter, Olivier (2011): How Not to Think of Land-Grabbing: Three Critiques of Large-Scale Investments in Farmland, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 38, no. 2, pp. 249-279
- (E) Altieri, M and V.M. Toledo (2011), 'The Agroecological Revolution in Latin America: Rescuing Nature, Ensuring Food Sovereignty and Empowering Peasants', *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 38, no.3, pp. 587-612.

Supplementary readings

- Hawkes, C and S Murphy (2010), 'An overview of global food trade'. In: C.Hawkes, C.Blouin, S.Henson, N.Drager and L.Dube (eds) *Trade Food Diet and Health: Perspectives and Policy Options*. Oxford & Ames: Wiley-Blackwell, pp.16-32. Available as an e-book through the SOAS Library.
- Bernstein, H (2010). *Class Dynamics of Agrarian Change* ch5
- Zoomers, Annelies (2010): Globalisation and the foreignisation of space: seven processes driving the current global land grab, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 37:2, 429-447.
- Goodman, David and Micheal Watts (1994), 'Reconfiguring the Rural or Fording the Devide?: Capitalist Restructuring and the Global Agro-Food System', *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 22, no. 1, pp. 1-49.
- Friedmann, H., 2004. 'Feeding the Empire: The Pathologies of Globalized Agriculture'. In *The Socialist Register 2005*, eds L. Panitch and C. Leys, 124–43. London: The Merlin Press.
- Friedmann, H. (2000), 'What on Earth is the Modern World-System? Foodgetting and Territory in the Modern Era and

- Beyond', *Journal of World-System Research*, vol. 6, no. 2, pp. 480-515.
- Evans, A. (2009). *The Feeding of the Nine Billion: Global Food Security for the 21st Century*. A Chatham House Report.
- FAO (2009). *The state of agricultural commodity markets 2009: High food prices and the food crisis – experiences and lessons learned*. Rome, Food and Agricultural Organisation of the United Nations.
- FAO, (2009), 'How to Feed the World in 2050', FAO report
- Foresight, (2011) *The Future of Food and Farming* Final Project Report. The Government Office for Science, London. See also Executive Summary. Both available from: <http://www.bis.gov.uk/foresight/our-work/projects/published-projects/global-food-and-farming-futures/reports-and-publications>
- Grigg, D. (1993) *The World Food Problem*. Blackwell.
- Headey, Derek and Shenggen Fan. 2010. *Reflections on the global food crisis : how did it happen? how has it hurt? and how can we prevent the next one?* IFPRI research monograph no 165. Available from: <http://www.ifpri.org/publication/reflections-global-food-crisis>
- IAASTD (2008) *Agriculture at a Crossroads: The Synthesis Report*. Washington, DC, USA: International Assessment of Agricultural Knowledge, Science and Technology for Development. www.agassessment.org/
- Lang T. and M. Heasman (2004). *Food Wars: The Global Battle for Mouths, Minds and Markets*. London: Earthscan.
- Oya, C (2010) 'Malfunctioning Markets'. *Brooker*. <http://www.thebrokeronline.eu/en/Special-Reports/Special-Report-The-heart-of-the-matter/Malfunctioning-markets>
- OECD (2008). *Rising Food Prices: causes and consequences*. Paris, Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development OECD).
- Piesse, J. and C. Thirtle (2009). "Three bubbles and a panic: An explanatory review of recent food commodity price events." *Food Policy* 34: 119–129.
- Toye, John, 2009. 'Development with Dearer Food: Can the Invisible Hand Guide us?', *Journal of International Development*, 21 (757-64).
- Special issue on Biofuels, Land and Agrarian Change, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 37, no. 4.
- Forum on Global Land Grabbing, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, vol. 38, no. 2.
- Special Issue on Land: A New Wave of Accumulation by Dispossession in Africa?, *Review of African Political Economy*, vol. 38, no. 128.

Essay question: Considering the nature of the current global food regime, what are, according to you, the most important dilemmas, challenges and contradictions that progressive states and/or peasant movements must confront in order to establish “sustainable” models of food production? Make sure you justify what you understand by sustainable.

9. Nutrition, food security and social protection (Deborah Johnston)

This lecture investigates definition and measurement of malnutrition and under-nutrition. What is meant by food security – and how can it be achieved? What is the link between national food self-sufficiency, food security and adequate nutrition – why is it that these three concepts can diverge? The policy debates are evaluated, including a discussion of; commercialisation of agriculture and development of food regimes; income safety nets; public health interventions; and improving status of women.

Core readings

- (E) Devereux, S., (2009) *Seasonality and Social Protection in Africa*, Working Paper no 11 (Jan 2009), Future Agricultures, available at http://www.futureagricultures.org/index.php?option=com_docman&task=cat_view&gid=184&Itemid=510&limitstart=10
- (E) Smith L. and L. Haddad, “Explaining Child Undernutrition in Developing Countries: A Cross-Country Analysis”, International Food Policy Research Institute, FCND Discussion Paper, Washington, April 1999. [Available from [IFPRI](http://www.ifpri.org/)]
- (E) P. Svedberg, “841 Million undernourished?”, *World Development*, 27 (12) (1999) pp. 2081-2098. [Available from [ScienceDirect](http://www.sciencedirect.com/)]
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Supplementary readings

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Essay question: 'Support to the poor and vulnerable should not be limited solely to agriculture'. Discuss.
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10. Agrarian Change: analytical approaches (Jens Lerche, Carlos Oya and Leandro Vergara-Camus)

It is now time to look in more detail at some of the underlying approaches to agrarian change which have already been introduced during the course. Two important and very different schools of thought are what have been termed 'populism' or 'neopopulism', and 'agrarian political economy'. This lecture will investigate the roots of this distinction, the rationales of the two approaches and critiques of them. It will then concentrate on their relevance today, including how they influence mainstream development approaches as well as those of major agrarian movements such as Via Campesina. As part of this it will be shown that the differences *within* the different approaches may be as important as the overall distinction between them, as theories and approaches have developed in response to the changing realities under neoliberalism.

Core readings

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- (E) Scoones, I. (2009), 'Livelihoods perspectives and rural development', *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 36(1): 171-96.

Read or re-read the following readings:

- (RP week 1) Byres, T. (2003) 'Paths of Capitalist Agrarian Transition in the Past and in the Contemporary World', in V.K. Ramachandran and M. Swaminathan (eds.) *Agrarian Studies: Essays on Agrarian Relations in Less-Developed Countries*. London: Zed Books.
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- (E) Cousins, B and I Scoones, 2010, Contested paradigms of 'viability' in redistributive land reform: perspectives from southern Africa, *Journal of Peasant Studies*, 37(1) 31–66
- (RP) Bernstein, H., 2009, 'Agrarian questions from transition to globalization', in A Haroon Akram-Lodhi and C Kay (eds), *Peasants and Globalization. Political economy, rural transformation and the agrarian question*, London: Routledge, pp. 239-61.

Supplementary readings

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- Sender J. and S. Smith, (1989), *Poverty, Class and Gender in Rural Africa*, Routledge, Chapter 6.
- Sender, J. and D. Johnston 2004, 'Searching for a Weapon of Mass Production in Rural Africa: Unconvincing Arguments for Land Reform', *Journal of Agrarian Change* 4(1&2): 142-64.
- van der Ploeg, Jan Douwe, 2010, 'The peasantries of the twenty-first century: the commoditisation debate revisited', [Journal of Peasant Studies](#) 37(1):1 – 30.

Essay question: Assess the strengths, weaknesses and usefulness of three different approaches to agrarian development with a focus on the particular historical experience of ONE country

Essay Deadline: Thursday 22 March 2012